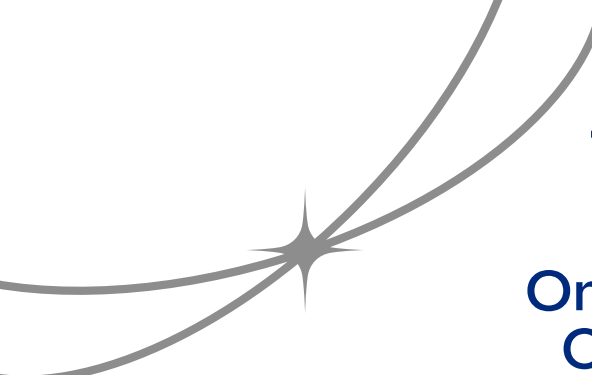


THE RECRUITER'S HANDBOOK

The Ultimate Guide to
Candidate Sourcing and Calling
Passive and Active Candidates.



By Jesse Hahn



THE RECRUITER'S HANDBOOK

On Successful Candidate Sourcing and Calling Passive or Active Candidates

Introduction

Over the years, we have seen the recruiting industry grow and develop, but one thing remains constant – it can be a challenge to find the ideal candidate. Your pool of candidates is not limited to those who are already in the market. Passive candidates are highly desired, yet many recruiters don't know how to identify them, let alone recruit them successfully.

In this book, you are getting a field guide to mastering the skills of identifying passive and active candidates, reaching out to get their attention and interest, and working with the hiring manager to successfully determine what makes a candidate ideal.

With today's technology, once you have a bulletproof job requirement, finding candidates inside of target companies is easier than ever. However, many recruiters have not been trained in this mode of recruitment, so get excited! Your job is about to get more exciting!



About the Author Jesse Hahn



As the founder and CEO of HTC Research, the largest passive candidate recruiting company in the US in the 80's and 90's I have earned a reputation for identifying and securing top talent for some of the world's most successful companies. With my deep knowledge of corporations' departments and positions, I have become an expert in the direct process of hunting passive candidates.

My success in the staffing and outsourcing industry led me to found several highly successful companies, including Avatur Staffing, Avatur Application Tracking System Software, Pierpoint Staffing, Pierpoint Global Staffing, and StraightSource Outsourcing Services.

Through these companies, I have set up over 17 candidate sourcing centers on five continents and have hired and trained thousands of recruiters and sources worldwide

Over my 30-year career, I have trained well over a thousand recruiters and sources in the USA, South America, Europe, Asia, and ANZ. Most of the individuals I have trained have gone on to make six-figure incomes in the staffing and recruitment industry or are head of staffing departments.

This book is a must-read for anyone who wants to be a candidate Sourcer/Recruiter, or a better recruiter, candidate sourcer, or HR professional looking to be at the top of the industry.





Why Recruit Passive Candidates

Passive candidates are not always the best candidates for a job, but they can be highly desirable because they are often employed, have valuable skills and experience, and may not be actively seeking a new job. Here are some reasons why passive candidates can be great potential hires:

Valuable skills and experience: Passive candidates often have valuable skills and experience that can be difficult to find in active job seekers. They may have developed specialized expertise in their field or have a proven track record of success in their current role.

Less competition: Since passive candidates are not actively applying for jobs, there is less competition for their attention. This can give employers an advantage in the hiring process, as they have a better chance of standing out and capturing the candidate's interest.

Strong work ethic: Passive candidates are often highly valued by their current employer and have a strong work ethic. They may be more likely to be dedicated and committed to their work, making them a great addition to any team.

Potential for long-term commitment: Passive candidates are not necessarily looking for a new job, so they may be more committed to a long-term opportunity if they are offered one. This can be beneficial for employers who are looking for a stable, long-term hire.

Industry connections: Passive candidates may have connections and networks in their industry that can be valuable for the employer. They may be able to bring in new clients or customers, expand the company's network, or offer valuable insights into the industry.



Active vs. Passive Candidate

Active Candidate

-  Has their resume on at least one Job Board
-  Has their public information on one or more networking sites
-  Applies to a job via the internet or job posting
-  Actively looking for a new job
-  Distracted by job search

Passive Candidate

-  Passive candidates represent 95% of the BEST talent in the workforce
-  No resume or public information posted anywhere
-  Not looking for a new job
-  Working happily at their current company



Type of Candidates We Target



How to Approach a Passive Candidate

Approaching a passive candidate for a job opening requires a different strategy compared to approaching an active candidate who is actively looking for a job. Here are some steps to consider:

Research the candidate: Before approaching a passive candidate, do some research on them to learn more about their background, experience, and skills. You can check their LinkedIn profile, professional social media accounts, and any online articles or publications they may have written.

Personalize your outreach: When reaching out to a passive candidate, be sure to personalize your message to them. Start by introducing yourself and your company, then explain why you think the candidate would be a great fit for the position. Be specific about why their skills and experience would be valuable to your company.

Highlight the benefits: Passive candidates are often happy in their current job and may not be actively looking for new opportunities. To entice them, highlight the benefits of the job, such as career growth opportunities, competitive compensation, and work-life balance.

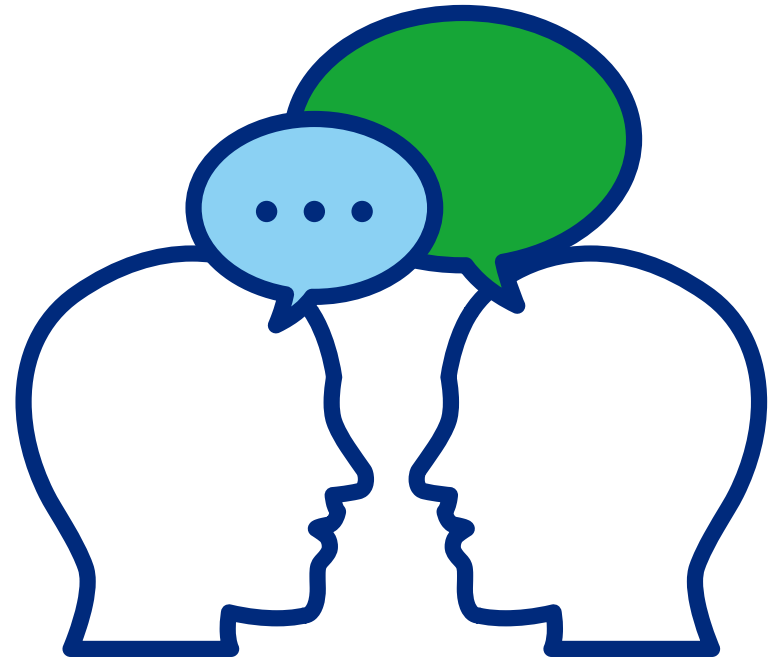
Be patient: Passive candidates may take longer to respond or may not be interested in the opportunity at all. Be patient and follow up with them after a week or two if you haven't heard back.

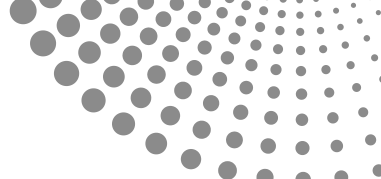
Keep the conversation open: Even if the candidate is not interested in the job at the moment, keep the conversation open and build a relationship with them. You never know when they may be open to new opportunities in the future.



When Calling a Passive Candidate, Always be in Control

- ✓ Be a consultant, not a salesperson!
- ✓ Have enthusiasm! Smile, be happy
- ✓ Your job is to help people find better jobs for more money!
- ✓ Relax, speak clearly, and slowly
- ✓ Emphasize key words
- ✓ Assumption can be a powerful tool!





Calling a Passive Candidate

Be a consultant, not a salesperson: Do you like salespeople? Neither do our candidates. But a consultant who works with you and has your interest and needs in mind is someone we always welcome.

Be enthusiastic - SMILE!: There is nothing more annoying than a robotic voice on the phone, especially when it sounds like they are reading a script. Be an actor! Use your voice, your emotions, and energy – get up and talk with your hands.

You're there to help them: YOU have the potential to give this persona a new job, a new life, more money, a better lifestyle. When you look at it as a great opportunity for them, they will know it!

Relax, speak clearly, speak slowly: When you're nervous you automatically speak fast. Make sure to slow down and pronounce your words clearly.

Emphasize key words: Use your voice – it's a powerful tool.

Use Assumption: It will always work in your favor. Assume this is a great opportunity for them. Assume they want to hear about it. Assume you're helping them. Assume you understand them.

LISTEN: Don't get so focused on your pitch that you don't listen to the candidate. Pay attention to their tone of voice, their words and their energy. Acknowledge it whenever you can.

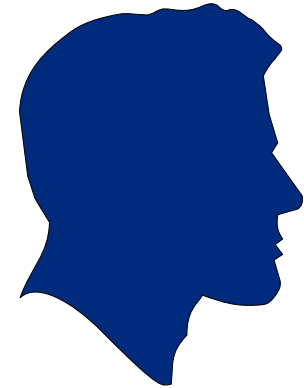


Passive Call Openers

YOU

Candidate

"Hello, my name is
_____, how are you?"



"I certainly understand that – let me
get right to the point..."



"Busy"

"I'm really sorry to hear that – let me
tell you why I'm calling."



"Not Well"

"That's great to hear! Let me tell you
why I'm calling."



"Great"





Let me Tell You Why I'm Calling...



"...My hiring manager asked me to contact you about an opportunity he has. He felt uncomfortable calling you directly. What he wanted to know is if **you are keeping your eyes and ears open to opportunities?**

Of course this is very confidential. I represent the company directly – only the hiring manager and I know we are speaking..."

"NO"

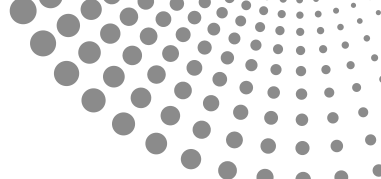
Note: They will say "no" at least 50% of the time.

You: "Great – of course you're not looking – everyone we speak with already has a job. No one calls you when you are unemployed sitting at home! Having a job is the perfect time to look at opportunities – confidentially, of course. You are AT LEAST keeping your eyes and ears open to opportunities, riiiiggghhht??"

Candidate: "What is the name of the company?" or "where are they located?"

You: "I'll tell you that and a lot more – I just need to confirm that you're open to opportunities..."





"YES"

You: "GREAT! I just have a few questions to ask and then I can forward the details to the hiring manager, who will contact you and discuss the job in detail...Just to confirm your background, you have...(insert title and some job qualifications)"

"Critical Information"

Get as much detail about their qualifications as you can.



DON'T FORGET!

"What is your salary range?" (This is for your benefit so we don't waste your time)

Base?
Commission?
Bonus?
Special perks?





"Next Steps"

You: "Ok, I will be emailing you the job description – please review it. You will be contacted from the hiring manager or another representative of _____ (company name) within a week or so."

When the hiring manager calls, it's very important that you call him/her back! It is a small world – you never know. He could be working for you someday or you working for him. If you are playing phone tag – leave the hiring manager a message with the best times to talk.

When you call – make sure you're in a place where you can have a relaxed, focused conversation – or set up a time when it's most convenient for both of you.

Try to ask enough questions during the conversation so that at the end of your meeting you can tell the hiring manager if you're interested in a face-to-face meeting.

Good luck and call me at _____ if you need anything else!"





If you're calling a C-Level executive, here is a sure-fire **ninja trick opener** that works every time! Simply start by saying either on the phone or in your email...

"My Board asked me to get in touch with you..."

When you mention a board, C-levels will listen!



Job Board Call Openers

YOU

Candidate



"Hello, my name is
_____, how are you?"

"I certainly understand that – let me
get right to the point..."

"I'm really sorry to hear that – let me
tell you why I'm calling."

"That's great to hear! Let me tell you
why I'm calling."



"Busy"

"Not Well"

"Great"



Let me Tell You Why I'm Calling...

"...I found your resume on (Monster, Indeed, Naukri, Careerbuilder, LinkedIn...) and wanted to know if **you are still keeping your eyes and ears open to opportunities?**"

"YES"

Continue with qualification and next steps as outlined previously for passive candidates.

"NO"

"Did you find a new position? And if so, are you happy?"

You may still try to recruit them, but if they are firm, always tell them about the position and ask "do you know of anyone who may be a fit for this great opportunity?"



When You Have to Leave a Message

PASSIVE CANDIDATE

Option 1

"Hello, my name is _____ and I represent _____ working in Singapore! My boss has asked me to contact you to set up a phone meeting. Please call me back at _____. Once again, my number is _____"

PASSIVE CANDIDATE

Option 2

"Hello, my name is _____. Some documents came across my desk today with your name on them and I need to discuss them with you. Please call me back at _____. Once again, my number is _____"

JOB BOARD CANDIDATE

"Hello, my name is _____. I found your resume on (board). I have an incredible opportunity I would like to speak with you about. Please call me back at _____. Once again, my number is _____"



Voicemail Techniques Goal: Establish Credibility & Create Interest

The Direct Recruit: You'll get better results if you recruit the person directly rather than be evasive. Say, for example: "I'd like to discuss a senior-level position in marketing with you." People are more likely to call back if there's something in it for them personally. Be vague about the title. "Senior level" or "executive level" work well.

I'm the Expert: Build up your reputation as someone worth knowing. "I'm not sure if you're heard my name before, but I'm recognized as a leading recruiter in the Java space. During a recent meeting at the _____ conference, your name was mentioned twice to me as someone I need to connect with regarding a search for a senior-level developer." People are more likely to call back if they can network with someone who is well-networked. Even if the current job is not a perfect fit, something in the future might be, so establish yourself as an important person to know.

The Name and Info Dropper: Mention someone or something important that the candidate will recognize. "I was just talking to the CFO at _____ regarding an interesting take on the new salary transparency law in California. This came up as part of a search I'm conducting for a senior-level Human Resources executive for a Fortune 200 company." Knowing important people and current issues gives you more credibility.



How to Overcome Phone Phobia

See phone time as **meeting new friends**.

Know your objective and **rehearse** what you will say ahead of time so it will be easy for you.

Understand that you don't have to score a touchdown on every play to **move the ball down the field**.

Collect a name, leave a message, secure an e-mail address **AND celebrate** those little victories immediately after the call for a minute or so.



Know when to fold them, have an exit call strategy worked out so if things become too bitter or too heated you can minimize the damage to your psyche. Also realize the vast majority of people aren't that hostile. If you are getting a high percentage of those type responses, the answer is to improve your technique.

Remember – they can smell your fear. Plan, Prepare & Execute. Realize **you don't have to win them all**, you do have to win at least 50% of the exchanges.

Six Core Selling Principles of Recruiting Top Talent

1

Know the Job

You must know the job to establish credibility and maintain control. Knowing the job allows you to become a partner with your hiring manager clients and a counselor for your candidates.

2

Use Solution or Consultative Selling Techniques

Using a consultative sales approach, the recruiter needs to have more personal involvement with candidates and the hiring manager.

As part of this, recruiters shouldn't look at success as closing the deal but in moving the process forward. They need to first find out what the person is capable of and interested in doing. Then, they need to move the process forward, using each step in the interviewing process as a means to exchange more and more information.

Six Core Selling Principles of Recruiting Top Talent

3

Close Upon an Objection

The key to solution-selling is the ability to overcome candidate and hiring manager concerns with a promise of getting the required information.



4

Persist - Don't Take "no" for an Answer

When candidates say they are not interested or won't proceed, it's usually due to one of two reasons: either they don't want to, or can't talk to you, or they're using incorrect information to make a decision. The "don't take no" advice is based on the idea that you need to consider a "no" as a request for more information, not a "no" decision. If the recruiter accepts the "no" as real, he'll normally go into defensive mode or try to intimidate the candidate insomeway.



Six Core Selling Principles of Recruiting Top Talent

5

Switch the Decision-Making Criteria



When evaluating career opportunities, most candidates instinctively overvalue short-term tactical criteria (such as location, company name, title, and compensation) instead of the long-term strategic career factors (like job stretch, chance to make an impact, job growth, and visibility).

On the evaluation side, most interviewers overvalue skills, presentation, the likability factor, and one or two narrow competencies, instead of the candidate's ability and motivation to handle all of the broad requirements of the job.

To be a good recruiter, you need to change the criteria that candidates and interviewers use to make decisions.

Six Core Selling Principles of Recruiting Top Talent

6

Defend Your Candidate



By the very nature of the relationship, hiring managers have more influence in the hiring decision than the recruiter. Despite this, recruiters need to be able to counter bad decisions made by hiring managers due to weak assessment skills. Since recruiters don't outrank their clients nor can they out talk them, recruiters can only do this by providing evidence of competency. Knowing the job is part of this.



How do I Best Present My Company to a Passive Candidate?

Presenting your company to a passive candidate requires a strategic approach to catch their interest and make a strong impression. Here are some tips to consider:

Start with a compelling introduction: Begin by introducing your company in a way that captures the candidate's attention. Highlight any impressive achievements or recent successes that demonstrate why your company is a great place to work.

Discuss the company culture: Passive candidates are often looking for a company that aligns with their values and work style. Discuss your company's culture and values to help them understand the type of environment they would be working in.

Highlight career growth opportunities: Passive candidates are often seeking opportunities for career growth and development. Explain how your company can offer them opportunities to advance their career and gain new skills.



Client Rules for Success



RULE #1

The 72 Hour Rule: Clients (the Hiring Manager or Recruiter) have 72 hours to contact a qualified, interested candidate. After 72 hours a greater percentage of candidates will drop out of the running. For one reason or another they lose interest.



RULE #2

Sell the Opportunity, Company, Product or Service FIRST: When a Hiring Manager or Recruiter calls the candidate for the first time, the first 15-25 minutes of the conversation should be selling the opportunity, company, product or service. After the "pitch" is completed and all the candidate's questions have been answered there is nothing wrong with continuing with the phone interview and qualifying the candidate for experience and background. This portion of the process will allow you to determine if a face-to-face interview is warranted.





How to Take a Job Description From a Hiring Manager That will Really Help you Find the Right Candidates

This is an **imperative** step to your recruiting success! You **MUST** get the hiring manager to spend the time required to fully answer all of the questions in the following pages.

Some managers will avoid this or try to short-cut it by assuming you know what they want or that their job description should be enough to go by.

We understand they're busy, but you need to convince them that the time invested in this step will save time in the future and speed up the recruiting process! After all, your success is their success!

The following questions and information gathering is extensive, but trust me - it **WILL** make your job easier!

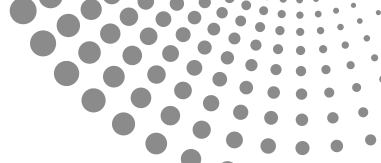




How to Take a Job Description From a Hiring Manager That will Really Help you Find the Right Candidates

- Have you interviewed any candidates for this job as of yet?
- What was the key reason for the not hiring any of the candidates interviewed?
- What are the Target companies or the kinds of companies you would like candidates out of?
 - Are you aware of any candidates that are currently interviewing with your company from the list of target companies you have given us?
 - Are there any candidates you do NOT want us to approach?
- What department(s) could these candidates be found in?
- What would their title(s) be?
- What degree(s) or certification(s) might the candidate have?
- Where is the position based?
 - What is a reasonable commute in that area?
 - If they are out of the commute range is there any relocation compensation involved? (Basic, standard, or full relocation)
- If this a management position, what level manager would they be? A Third Level Manager at a large company might have a title of VP while at a smaller company they would be a Senior Manager. Titles are not as important as what Level manager they are. (See Manager Level)





How to Take a Job Description From a Hiring Manager That Will Really Help You Find the Right Candidates Cont...

- What is the absolute minimum number of year's experience that this candidate must have with each skill set?
 - Definition: Absolute Minimum: "If you ask for 5 years to be the minimum number of years experience with xyz skill set and we identify someone with 4 years and 11 months you will not be sent that candidate. Be very specific."
 - What is the maximum amount of salary you want the candidate to be currently making?
 - What are the key search words we should look for in a candidates resume?
 - Compensation: what is the comp for this position? How does that compare to the industry? If we find highly qualified candidates who are making more then the salary range, do you want them? (See Compensation for more information)
 - What is the sizzle to the sale? What short 10-second statement can we use to get the candidate interested in the job?
 - Relocation? Travel?
 - Future opportunities
 - **What other skills must the candidate have to be qualified? These must be very specific skills that the candidate must have or he or she will be disqualified!**
- 



Drilling Down on Educational Requirements

For some positions, the educational requirements may be stringent, while others may not. Understanding the flexibility – or lack thereof – of educational requirements helps you when assessing a candidate's qualifications.



- What is the minimum acceptable education? Do they have to have a 4-year degree?
- Does the candidate need to have a specific degree or be disqualified?
- If the candidate has a Masters, can the candidate have fewer years experience in his or her job?
- If the candidate has a PHD, can the candidate have even fewer years experience in his or her job?
- If looking for a technical degree only are Physics, Mathematics, BSCS, and BSEE acceptable?
- If the candidate does not have a four-year degree how many years experience may be acceptable as a replacement for the 4-year degree?



Drilling Down on Compensation

Depending on the company, there could be a variety of compensation packages, perks, equity and more. Understanding the details of the maximum compensation and how flexible it is, is critical – especially for your candidate!

- It is important that there be a limit on what a candidate is currently making so that the passive candidates provided are not making more money that your company can offer as a raise.
- To be assured that the candidates are "hirable" there needs to be a limit on how much you want the candidate to be currently making either in total compensation (sales people are better judged by total compensation) or by salary alone.
- A good formula for the maximum salary limit might be 10% less than the maximum you can pay the candidate.
- An additional factor might be stock! If the maximum salary is \$100K, and the candidate is making \$110K, could the 10K differential be made up in stock?

The last question is as important as all the others, but it is the least asked!





Understanding the Manager Level (1st, 2nd, 3rd)

There are many levels of management, from first level supervisor through C-level. Determining the level of the position is important when targeting candidates.

Q: What level of management will the candidate be?

- **1st Level Manager:** Does not have managers reporting to them. A 1st level manager is responsible for a group of non-managerial employees. Depending on the size of the company, titles could be: Lead, Senior, Manager, or even Vice President
- **2nd Level Manager:** Responsible for 1st level managers. Possible titles include Lead Manager, Senior Manager, Director, Vice President, Senior Vice President or even General Manager.
- **3rd Level Manager:** Responsible for 2nd level managers. Possible titles include Senior Director, Vice President, General Manager, Senior Vice President, or C-level (CIO, CTO, CMO)

Additional Questions:

- How many people does the manager need to be managing currently or have managed in the past? (This question will also help to laser in on the right candidate who has the right management experience).
 - What size department does this candidate need to be managing now or have managed in the past? (This question also breaks down the 2nd or 3rd Level Manager's responsibilities by size of department).
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Determining Target Companies

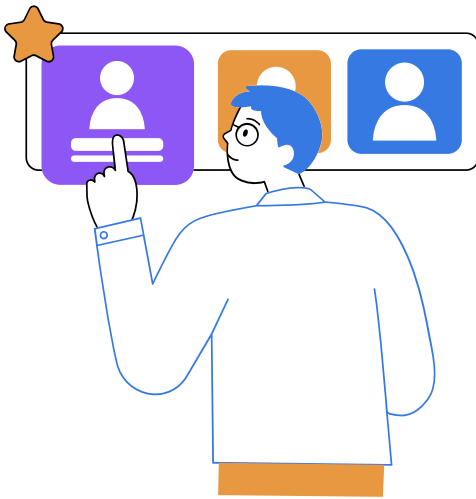
Your hiring manager may be the expert in identifying target companies. Some sample questions to ask the hiring manager are (your questions will vary depending upon the position)...

- What type of target companies do you want us to focus on?
- Enterprise Software? Oracle, SAP, IBM, HP, etc...
- Shrink wrap software? Norton, Microsoft, etc...
- What about companies that sell to large retailers? Google, Apple, McAfee, HP, Intuit, etc...
- What about companies over X million in sales?
- What about companies that have purchased and integrated companies into their own company?
- How about payroll companies?



Target Departments

Next you need to figure out which departments your candidates may be found at the target companies. Some options may be...



Marketing

- Corporate Marketing, Direct, Product, Channel, Online

Sales

- Inside, Direct, Channel, Online, Pre-sales, Named Accounts

IT

- Support, Systems Admin, Telco, Development

Software

- Development, QA, Architecture, Testing

Corporate

- HR, Admin, Executive, Operations, Finance, Purchasing





Titles

Determining a person's title is can be tricky, but it's good to know what options they may be called to fine tune your targeting.

- It's important to remember that titles vary from company to company.
- What title will the candidate have at the target companies?
- What are some other possible titles a competitor might use instead?



HELLO
my name is

Account Manager
Account Executive
Sales Professional
Client Executive
Sales Manager



Location, Location, Location

When talking with the hiring manager about the specifications of the job, it's important to know what options you have if you find a candidate that needs to relocate. Ask the hiring manager...

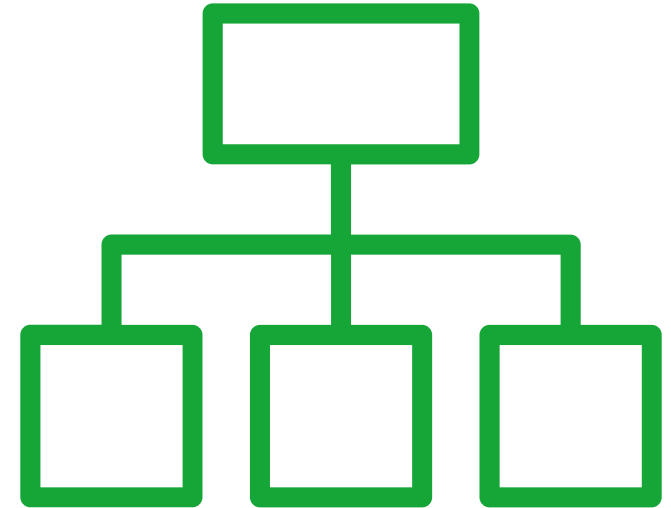


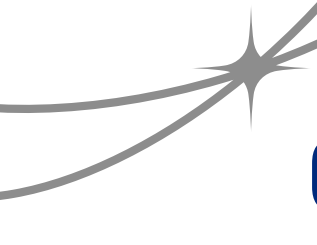
- Where will the position be based? A specific city, area, region?
- If the position is out of a reasonable commute radius, is there relocation available?
- Is it a basic, standard, or full relocation package? What is included in the package?



How to Map a Company

- Collect the names of all your target companies.
- Go online to the company career page and find out the title of the types of people you will be targeting, i.e. "account manager".
- Create a spreadsheet for each company, ie. SAP-Beijing- Account Managers, or Microsoft-Singapore-Software Engineers.
- Using all of our tools available, job boards, networking sites, etc. Collect the names, contact info, resumes or bio's of **EVERYONE** currently working at the company.
- Enter all of this info on the Excel or Google sheet and attach the bio or resume of each person.
- Go through the list, chances are you will have a few candidates that are a match to your job. Call and screen them. Keep their info handy, you might need it.





Coaching Your Candidate - 10 Reasons Not to Accept a Counter-Offer

1. Question how much the company actually values what you do. Would they have made the counter-offer if you were not leaving?
 2. From where is the money for the counter-offer coming? Is it your next raise early? (All companies have strict wage and salary guidelines which must be followed).
 3. Your company will immediately start looking for a new person at a lower salary price.
 4. Your loyalty will always be in question in the future.
 5. When promotion time comes around, your employer will remember who was loyal, and who wasn't.
 6. When times get tough, your employer will begin the cutback with you.
 7. The same circumstances that now cause you to consider a change will repeat themselves in the future, even if you accept a counteroffer.
 8. Statistics show that if you accept a counteroffer, the probability of voluntarily leaving in six months or being let go within one year is extremely high.
 9. Accepting a counter-offer is an insult to your intelligence and a blow to your personal pride, knowing that you were bought.
 10. Once the word gets out, the relationship that you now enjoy with your co-workers will never be the same. You will lose the personal satisfaction of peer group acceptance.
- 



Conclusion

The principles and practices outlined in this book comes from decades of experience, not only in the trenches, but also from teaching them to recruiters all over the world.

Your success as a recruiter is dependent upon how well you embrace and practice these principles.

I wish you much success – happy hunting!



BONUS #1

Success Tips for the In-House Recruiter

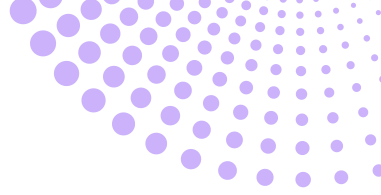
*For RFT and Contract
Recruiters*



By

Claudia Loens

Silicon Valley High Tech
Recruiting Consultant for
23 years.



Introduction

Jesse Hahn's "The Recruiter's Bible" is an amazing resource for anyone looking to break into a sourcing or recruiting role. Cold calling candidates is a dying art. Long before email and networking sites, cold calling was the only way to find and recruit passive candidates. Learning and mastering the skills he laid out in his book will give any recruiter a leg up on the competition and help them grow their recruiting career!

BUT...

What if you could not only master his passive candidate recruiting techniques, but could **ALSO** learn how to be or become a successful in-house recruiter? That's what this bonus is all about. Getting the candidate's interest is one thing, but managing the internal process is a whole additional ball game.

By implementing the tips in this book **WITH** the passive candidate recruitment techniques, you are sure to have a successful recruiting career!

So, let's go!



The Role of the In-House Recruiter

There are typically 2 types of recruiters inside corporations. They are:

The “Regular” Recruiter – is usually an employee or contract recruiting consultant. They are responsible for the overall recruitment process, including, communication with all involved parties. They manage the hiring managers’ and candidates’ expectations from the time the requisition is approved to the day the candidate starts their employment with the company. (For the sake of this book I will focus on this recruiter)



The Sourcer – these can also be employees or recruiting consultants. Their role is to work with the recruiter to search for and qualify candidates for positions. While they are often the first person to speak with a candidate, they are generally behind the scenes and don’t work with the hiring manager. (HINT – these folks would benefit greatly from Jesse’s passive candidate strategies!)

The Hiring Manager

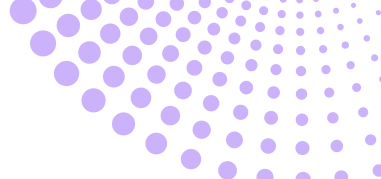
The first time you meet with a hiring manager (HM), you will have the following objectives:

- Learn the HM's background and understand the basics about their organization, their team, their products/services and hiring goals.
- If you have a job requisition, you have a place to start, but often times you may not. Go through the questions about taking the job order from Jesse's book in previous pages. Additional questions I like to ask are:
 - Will you be conducting the first technical qualification interview or will someone on your team?
 - How soon are you looking to fill this position? (Usually it's "yesterday" 😊)
 - Have you identified the key contributors to the interview team? And if so, have you structured the interviews for them? (More on this later)
- Set expectations
 - Tell the HM about your process and how soon you intend to have qualified resumes and/or candidates to them.
 - Get a commitment for their turnaround time – in other words, if you send them a candidate, will they reply with their thoughts/next steps within 48 hours max?
 - Also get a commitment to set aside time for this very important process. Time to review candidates, conduct phone and in-person interviews and gather feedback from the interview team in a timely manner.
- Together, determine how you will measure and report on progress.

When to Say "No"

There are times when a hiring manager is also a micro-manager or has unrealistic expectations of you. In general, use your best judgement but remember that your objective is to find and qualify candidates, while ushering them through the process. You are not an Admin and you most likely have other hiring managers and requisitions to juggle.

you know?
it's
OKAY
to say
=NO=



When Saying No is OK

Here are a few situations when it may be appropriate to push back a little:

- If they want to **meet daily for status**. You need time to do the actual recruiting with regular communication in between. A weekly meeting is usually enough for an overall status.
 - Similarly, if they want you to attend a **weekly staff meeting with their team**, this will also limit the amount of time you can actually recruit. If they insist, ask to be the first on the agenda and leave after your update.
 - **Crazy reporting**. Most Applicant Tracking Systems (ATS) have reports that should suffice when you need to provide a report to your HM. When an HM requests additional or separate reports that require your manual creating (like spreadsheets). This is not a good use of your time. However, if you're working with a grassroots, start-up, it may be the only way to provide updates. Use your best judgement.
 - **Interview Scheduling** – in most established companies, and even some start-ups, there are department admins or dedicated staffing coordinators who can set up interviews. Setting up the initial phone interview for a hiring manager is usually as far as you should go. Your expertise is in recruiting, not administrative work. And believe me – one interview schedule with multiple attendees can take HOURS!
- 

Tips for Successful Interviews

The interview cycle is a critical piece of the hiring puzzle. A bad interview experience for the candidate could turn them off. And a poorly executed interview could lead to poor hiring decisions.

Other than being on the interview team, many recruiters don't get involved in the actual interview cycle or how it is managed. For the most part, the HM owns the interview process, but if it's not well run, your work will be much harder. Here are some ways you can help facilitate a successful interview cycle:

Interview Training

Find out if the members of the interview team have had interview training. If not, consider having a short team meeting and going over some questions and approach. Believe it or not, some members of the interview team won't realize that the candidate is nervous and you should spend a few minutes at the beginning breaking the ice and building rapport. That's just one example!



Tips for Successful Interviews

Interview Team Roles

Make sure the HM has communicated the roles and line of questioning for each interviewer. They should be assigned a specific area of the job requirement. For example, one might focus their questions on coding examples, while another may ask about project management. There is no worse experience for a candidate than to talk to 5 people back-to-back who all ask the same rote questions, like: “tell me about your work experience.” Or, “where do you see yourself in 5 years”. That interview day for the candidate was boring and exhausting. Plus, your team does not come away with a good understanding of the candidate’s capabilities, personality or ability to do the job.

Back-up Interviewers

Have back-ups. Make sure your HM has a back-up interviewer or two. Stuff happens and it’s better to have a less qualified interviewer talk to a candidate than to have them sit in the room by themselves for 30 minutes.



Tips for Successful Interviews



Gathering Feedback

Gather feedback immediately. The HM should gather the feedback directly from each team member or as an “interview wrap session” where they do a round table discussion of the candidate. A written evaluation of the candidate is another good way to obtain feedback. A simple thumbs-up or thumbs-down does not work. As the recruiter, ask for as much feedback as you can from the HM after they get it. This will help you fine-tune the requirements and cultural fit of future candidates if this one is not the right fit.

Recruiter Role

If you’re **not one of the interviewers**, try to greet the candidate when they arrive or walk them out when they’re done. You’ve likely had several conversations with them at this point and it will help them feel more comfortable if you are the first person they see. On the other hand, if you walk them out, you get a moment to ask them how it went on their side and set expectations for next steps.

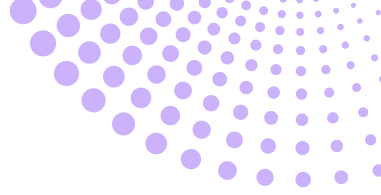
If you **ARE one of the interviewers**, first ask the HM what they would like you to focus on. In general, they will probably want you to help determine if the person is a fit for the company culture, find out what motivates them, and do a pre-close (more on that later).

Communicating with Candidates



You are likely to be the main contact for your candidates. Good HMs want to be, but sometimes they are just too busy managing the team. Therefore, your relationship with your candidates is a vitally important. Here are some tips:

- Always – ALWAYS – respond to the candidate when they ask for an update, even if it's taking a painfully long time for the HM to give you an update on their side. Think about how eager and excited you have been when you've waited for a decision from a company you're very interested in!
- Set the expectations up front. Be as frank with the candidate as you can about the process without being negative or giving out confidential information. If it's going to take 2 weeks for the hiring manager to review resumes because they are traveling – tell them! The better you are at communicating all the way around, the better recruiter you will be.



Discussing Compensation

Jesse went over some compensation tips in his book, but here are a few more thoughts.

If you are doing the initial phone screen, it's important to get as much compensation information as possible. Sometimes a candidate doesn't want to reveal what they are currently making because they feel underpaid or don't want to lowball if it is a better paying salary. This discussion can be awkward, but it's critical to all parties.

If they are open, here are some questions to ask:

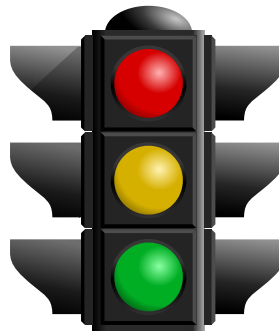
- What is your current base salary?
 - Do you have a bonus and if so, what is the percentage? (if they don't know ask the amount of the last 2 bonuses) How frequently do you receive the bonus?
 - Does your company match your 401k contribution? If so, by how much?
 - Do you have stock options or RSU (Restricted Stock Units)? How many and what is the current value? How vested are you?
 - Do you have any special benefits, like extra vacation time or a remote working situation?
 - When is your next review?
 - Will you be leaving anything on the table if you left within the next month?
 - What is your salary expectation?
 - If they are already at the top of the salary range, tell them and ask "Are you interested in continuing?" Then: "I can't say we won't be able to meet your expectations, but I want to be up front about where we're both at. If it comes down to it, we would make you the best offer we can." Let them answer and go from there.
- 

Discussing Compensation - Candidate Pushback

If they don't want to share this information, here's what you can say:

"I totally understand your reluctance to share your salary, but I want to assure you that I am your advocate. It's my role to make sure we completely understand where you're currently at so that we can potentially craft a competitive offer that you will accept. We don't want to waste your time or ours. So will you share it?"

90% of the time they will! The other 10% may represent a red flag and you should discuss it with the hiring manager.



Pre-Closing Tips

If you know from your hiring manager that they have chosen a candidate, it's a good idea to start the pre-closing process, even if you're not ready to present an approved offer. This helps you avoid surprises during the offer stage. There is nothing worse than going through the offer approval process only to have your candidate spring a surprise on you that makes your offer unappealing.

At this point, the pre-closing a candidate is like pre-closing on a sale. You are looking to address objections, prep them for what's to come and get them excited about the next steps.



Pre-Closing Tips

The main information to get and relay includes:

- Ask if they are interviewing anywhere else, where they are in the process and how soon do they expect an offer, if applicable.
- If they are interviewing anywhere else and they've also talked with your HM and team, ask them how your role, team and company compares to the other companies. (Be sure to LISTEN and watch or hear their body language/tone!)
- Prepare them by saying “if we come back with a really great offer, are you ready to make a decision?” – this is important because you want to know they aren't “shopping” for offers and will consider your offer seriously. And if they say they need more time, ask, “what would it take to help you make the decision faster?”
- Another important question to ask, is “what would you do if your boss comes back and matches our offer or gives you a counteroffer?” This is when you refer to Jesse's great tips for addressing a counteroffer.
- If you accept our offer, how soon would you be able to start?
- Recap what is great about the position, the company, the benefits and the team. **Get them excited!**



When the Candidate is not Chosen

Rejecting a candidate is one of the hardest parts of the job of a recruiter. Here is a simple script you can use either on the phone or via email.

"We really appreciate the time you spent sharing your background and learning about us. Unfortunately, we won't be moving forward with an offer at this time. If something changes, we will let you know and we will keep your resume handy for future opportunities. Thank you for your interest!"

Do NOT get into the details of why they don't get the offer. Never tell them there was a more qualified candidate. If they push you to know why, you can say: "It just wasn't the right fit at this time."

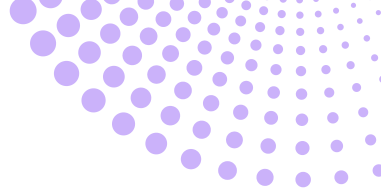


The Offer Stage

The HM ultimately decides what the offer should be, with your help and your human resources team. You likely have salary ranges for the positions which have been created using annual market data. Helping the hiring manager determine a fair, and appealing offer, is part of your job. Here are some tips:



- Give a complete overview of the candidate's current compensation package – include **EVERYTHING** you obtained from them.
- If you had the “pre-close” conversation with them, tell the hiring manager what you believe it will take to get an acceptance.
- Refer to your internal HR team and the salary ranges for the position – have this information handy when you are meeting with the hiring manager.



The Offer Stage

- If this is a technical position, review the candidate's background with the hiring manager to gauge how closely they meet the position requirements. Discuss whether they are more or less experienced than the current job level. Also discuss any areas where the candidate exceeds the job requirements or missing experience. For example:
 - If the candidate has leadership experience, but the position doesn't require it, find out from the HM if they could upgrade the position or utilize the leadership skills. This may be a great bonus!
 - On the other hand, if a candidate has less experience than you want or doesn't know a particular technology, advise your HM to look at the position level. It may be a stretch for the candidate or maybe the level should be down graded. Just keep in mind that when a person interviews for a "Senior Software Engineer" and you offer "Software Engineer", they may lose interest.
 - Ask your hiring manager about the other members of the team and how they stack up against this new person. For many companies in certain recruitment markets, it's hard for the employees' salaries to stay at market level. Employers may be offering higher salaries to be competitive, while current employees lag. This is a good time to bring in an HR Business Partner to look at the organization.
 - If the hiring manager does not want to meet the expectations of the candidate, discuss alternatives. For instance, if they don't want to pay the salary level, ask about a hiring bonus or extra stock. See how creative you can be to make a solid offer.
 - Discuss what you would do if the candidate has multiple offers.
- 

When the Candidate has Multiple Offers

In Silicon Valley we were constantly competing with other companies for talent. I remember one company who would sit their candidates down and map out on the whiteboard exactly how long it would take them to make a million dollars with their stock! How do you compete with that??? Maybe you can't but here are some tactics to try...

- **Bring in the heavy hitters!** Ask an executive in the department or company to give the candidate a call. It's pretty impactful when you get a call from a Sr. VP or C-level team member who is trying to close you! Many candidates love this. Make sure you prep the candidate for the call and let them know how cool it is that this busy, important executive is calling them!
- **Bring them into the fold.** Invite them to attend a company event, group lunch or project meeting. Have them engage with your team before they make a final decision.
- **Send them swag.** Company gear is fun to receive, especially if they love your technology or brand. Sending it with a written offer is a nice touch.
- **Offer an additional perk,** such as a few extra days of unofficial vacation time or the ability to work remotely a couple of days per week.



A Word About Counteroffers

Jesse has a good section of the book which addresses counter offers – be sure to read it! In my experience, if you have a frank discussion about the possibility of a counter offer early on, you can usually tell if a candidate is “shopping”. How they talk about their current employer is strong evidence towards whether they would consider a counter or not.

Rarely do candidates come right out and say they are leaving because they are underpaid, but that may be the underlying issue. Pay close attention to this part of the conversation with the candidate.



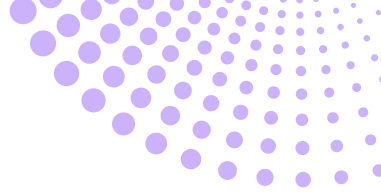
The Onboarding Process

During the time between the offer acceptance and the candidate's start date, be sure to check in with them and have the hiring manager check in too.

Onboarding is usually handled by the hiring team and/or their admin assistant. If they ask you for help or advice for a smooth onboarding experience, here are things which should be in place on your new hire's first day (note – it's not your job to do this, only advise, if asked).



- **A place to sit** – yes, really! Have a work area already set up with necessary supplies, a laptop, chair and monitor. A name tag on the wall is also a nice touch!
- **Accounts set up** – Make sure IT has everything they need to get the new hire their company email, and all logins. Have it ready in the workspace for the new employee.
- **A schedule** – usually the first half day will be for orientation (benefits overview, paperwork, etc). When that is completed, have a couple of days' worth of meetings and trainings already scheduled.
- **A group lunch** – ideally a group lunch or lunch with the hiring manager will happen on their first day.



Conclusion

Being a corporate recruiter can be fun and exciting. It is very satisfying to help “build” a company, one hire at a time. The tips provided in this bonus section were intended to help you learn or fine-tune your recruiting approach. I hope you have a fabulous recruiting career!

About the Author

Claudia Loens got her first experience in Human Resources at the age of 19. She quickly learned that being a recruiter was a role she was born to pursue! Starting as a staffing coordinator, within 3 years she learned about recruiting and got her first official requisition. Since then, she went on to become an independent contractor working in Silicon Valley company icons like Intuit, Yahoo!, McAfee, and Logitech. She led large teams and projects, and was sometimes the only recruiter in a small startup.

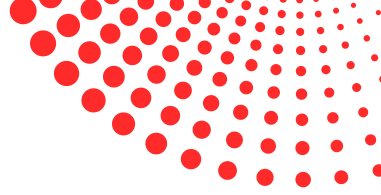
After 23 years in high tech, Claudia left to pursue her creative passions through her boutique marketing firm, Wordflirt. Today, she helps entrepreneurs and small businesses grow through digital marketing and life/business coaching.



BONUS #2

How to Break Into Your First Recruiting Gig

*A Ninja trick for landing your first
or next recruiting assignment.*



Looking for Your First or Next Role? Try This...

Sometimes it's hard to break into the recruiting field or maybe your career is stuck. Here is a tactic that Jesse teaches and has used to win multiple new assignments with companies he's trying to land.

Do Your Homework

- Learn as much as you can about your target company and study their open positions.
- Go on their site or a job board and look for an open position that appears to have been open for a long time.
- Go through Jesse's job mapping exercise for that position and look for candidate.

Act "as if"

- Reach out to the candidates that you find who appear qualified. Use Jesse's passive candidate calling script and act as if you were assigned to recruit for the position.
- Do not give out the company name, but go through all of the steps and act as if you are already representing the company.

Present Your Candidates

- Use LinkedIn to try to determine who the hiring manager or recruiter is for the position.
- Contact them and let them know you have a qualified, interested candidate you would like to present for free. If they ask why you would do it for free, tell them you are not a contingency recruiter, you are looking to build trust and show them your skills in the event they may need a recruiter or sourcer on the team.